succeeds in its plans, now or later, he declared that he would leave the country. Fine, and what about the hundreds of thousands who cannot leave?

One of my uncles was already a Zionist (Blau-Weiss, a German Jewish youth movement) before World War II, and so was my mother. She could not convince my father but visited Palestine with another of her brothers sometime in the mid-1930s. This brother did not like the nationalism of the Jewish community there. Instead he turned to anthroposophy and emigrated to Sweden. Zionists were right in the context of the times, of course, but their nationalism became a curse that exploded after 1967 and 1977 (Begin's accession to power). Poor Begin: compared to Netanyahu and his acolytes, he was a Polish gentleman.

A law allowing for the dismissal of the National Library director was voted when the attorney-general left the committee room for a few minutes. Gangster methods. It is called the "Law for the Transparency of the National Library."

Former prime minister Ehud Barak declares that soldiers confronted with an illegal order should refuse to obey it … I wonder when Netanyahu will give the order to arrest Barak. You think that I am joking: Knesset member Tally Gotliv demanded Barak's arrest in a television interview. Incidentally, Barak was Netanyahu's commander in Sayeret Matkal, the most elite special forces unit of the army.

Netanyahu is reportedly closing the day in a confidential meeting offering ministers arguments to better "hit" the opposition with. The man is truly poisonous (I just read that "poisonous" has become a word for all occasions in our idyllic country).

In the meantime, air force pilots are threatening to refuse to fly. They will possibly be followed by Intelligence reserve officers. More than high-tech people moving out, turmoil in the army will create the deepest of reactions. The army is the idealized self-image of the country.